

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Finance English



Conversation lab

12 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For accounting, FP&A, treasury, banking, investments, audit, risk, corporate finance, and finance-adjacent teams.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Monthly Close: Revenue Miss or Timing Issue?

02 Forecast Review: Aggressive Sales Assumptions

03 Cash Runway: Profit Is Not Cash

04 Covenant Monitoring: Early Warning

05 Investment Committee: Duration and Spread Risk

06 Credit Underwriting: Strong Growth, Weak Coverage

07 M&A Diligence: EBITDA Add-Back Challenge

08 Pricing and Margin: Discounting Pressure

09 Audit Issue: Control Deficiency or Material Weakness?

10 FX Hedge Debate

11 Performance Presentation: Fair, Accurate, Complete

12 Board Update: Liquidity, Leverage, and Capital Allocation

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Monthly Close: Revenue Miss or Timing Issue?

Finance reviews monthly results before sending the executive package.

Roles: Controller / FP&A lead / Finance business partner

Controller: Revenue is 4 percent below forecast. Is this a real miss or timing?

FP&A lead: Part of it is timing. Two enterprise renewals slipped into next month.

Finance business partner: Can we separate accounting timing from underlying demand? Revenue recognition depends on the actual contracts, performance, and applicable accounting policy, not just signature date. Let's reconcile those details before calling this a timing-only variance.

Controller: What should the commentary say?

Finance business partner: The renewals are one reported driver, but the accounting bridge still needs verification. We should also assess the SMB churn data before drawing a conclusion about recurring demand.

Controller: I will reconcile renewal timing with the revenue-recognition entries before we finalize the bridge.

Finance business partner: Please include the churn evidence and distinguish confirmed drivers from the open analysis.

Notice the professional language

Good finance commentary separates accounting timing from business demand.

A variance explanation should state driver, recurrence, confidence, and risk.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Forecast Review: Aggressive Sales Assumptions

A business unit submits a forecast that assumes a sharp Q4 recovery.

Roles: Business owner / CFO / Finance business partner

Business owner: The pipeline supports the forecast. We just need the team to execute.

CFO: Pipeline is not the same as committed revenue.

Finance business partner: The upside case is possible, but the base case should reflect conversion rate, sales-cycle length, and historical slippage. What evidence supports a conversion rate above the trailing average?

Business owner: We have a new campaign.

Finance business partner: Then I would model the campaign as a sensitivity, not the base case, until we see qualified leads converting.

Business owner: I will supply historical conversion and slippage by stage.

Finance business partner: Then we can compare a defensible base case with the proposed upside.

Notice the professional language

Respectful pushback focuses on assumptions and evidence.

Finance language can separate base case, upside case, and sensitivity.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Cash Runway: Profit Is Not Cash

A startup leadership team reviews runway after slower collections.

Roles: CEO / Treasury / Finance business partner

CEO: We are close to breakeven, so why is cash still tight?

Treasury: Collections slowed, and prepaid annual contracts are lower than planned.

Finance business partner: The income statement improved, but working capital moved against us. DSO increased, and deferred revenue growth slowed, so cash came in later than revenue recognition suggests.

CEO: What levers do we have?

Finance business partner: We can assess collections, spending timing, and funding scenarios with the responsible teams. The cash forecast should show assumptions and constraints explicitly, including any financing that is not yet available.

CEO: I will update the receipts schedule and identify what remains unconfirmed.

Finance business partner: Bring that alongside the downside cash outlook so management can assess actual flexibility.

Notice the professional language

Deferred revenue - Cash received before revenue is recognized.

Working capital - Operational assets and liabilities such as receivables, inventory, and payables.

DSO - Days sales outstanding; a measure of collection speed for receivables.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Covenant Monitoring: Early Warning

Treasury sees leverage approaching a covenant threshold.

Roles: Treasurer / Business unit CFO / Finance business partner

Treasurer: If Q3 EBITDA lands at the downside case, leverage gets close to the covenant.

Business unit CFO: But we will not breach unless Q4 is also weak.

Finance business partner: True, but we should treat this as an early warning. The lender conversation is easier before a breach than after one.

Treasurer: What do we need?

Finance business partner: A rolling covenant forecast, downside mitigation plan, and a decision on whether to seek an amendment, add equity cushion, or reduce discretionary spend.

Treasurer: I will check the definitions and thresholds in the actual loan agreement.

Finance business partner: Use those in the forecast and route any proposed lender discussion through the authorized team.

Notice the professional language

EBITDA - Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization; often adjusted but not a cash-flow substitute.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Investment Committee: Duration and Spread Risk

A portfolio manager explains fixed-income underperformance.

Roles: Client / Portfolio manager / Finance business partner

Client: Why did we underperform if the bond portfolio is conservative?

Portfolio manager: Rates moved higher, and credit spreads widened at the same time.

Finance business partner: The portfolio stayed within mandate, but duration exposure hurt absolute returns, and spread widening hurt relative performance versus short-duration peers.

Client: Should we reduce risk now?

Finance business partner: We can shorten duration, improve credit quality, or hold the allocation if your horizon supports it. The tradeoff is lower rate sensitivity versus potential income and reinvestment opportunity.

Client: I will compare the options against the mandate and current objectives.

Finance business partner: Please include the risks and assumptions before requesting an investment decision.

Notice the professional language

Client communication should explain performance without making hindsight sound easy.

Use mandate, benchmark, horizon, and tradeoff language.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Credit Underwriting: Strong Growth, Weak Coverage

A bank credit committee reviews a borrower seeking a larger facility.

Roles: Relationship manager / Credit officer / Finance business partner

Relationship manager: The borrower is growing fast and wants more capacity.

Credit officer: Growth is good, but cash conversion is weak.

Finance business partner: Revenue growth does not automatically support more debt. DSCR is below our target in the downside case, and customer concentration increases repayment risk.

Relationship manager: What structure would make it approvable?

Finance business partner: We can evaluate structures and conditions through credit review, but none of those changes guarantees approval. Let's compare the downside cash flows and risk implications before recommending terms.

Relationship manager: I will collect the updated borrower records and confirm their reporting period.

Finance business partner: Then credit can assess the request using the complete file.

Notice the professional language

DSCR - Debt service coverage ratio; cash flow relative to required debt payments.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

M&A Diligence: EBITDA Add-Back Challenge

Corporate development reviews seller-adjusted EBITDA.

Roles: Seller advisor / Buyer finance / Finance business partner / Deal lead

Seller advisor: The adjusted EBITDA add-backs are standard. These costs are non-recurring.

Buyer finance: Some of them appear to be ongoing operating costs.

Finance business partner: We can accept one-time legal settlement costs if documented, but the customer support add-back looks recurring. Removing it lowers EBITDA and increases the purchase multiple.

Deal lead: How should we proceed?

Finance business partner: Request support for each add-back and assess its effect on normalized earnings and valuation. Working-capital mechanisms and contingent consideration address different deal questions and need their own analysis and qualified review.

Seller advisor: I will request documentary support for each disputed adjustment.

Finance business partner: Keep the seller's assertion separate from the buyer's verified analysis.

Notice the professional language

EBITDA - Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortization; often adjusted but not a cash-flow substitute.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Pricing and Margin: Discounting Pressure

Sales wants approval for a large discount to close a strategic customer.

Roles: Sales / Finance / Finance business partner

Sales: If we approve the discount, we close the logo this quarter.

Finance: The discount compresses gross margin and sets a pricing precedent.

Finance business partner: Can we separate strategic value from unit economics? The deal may be worth doing, but the base price should not become the reference point for renewals or similar customers.

Sales: What is the finance recommendation?

Finance business partner: I would compare the proposed terms and longer-term margin effects before recommending approval. Any discount, volume commitment, or renewal provision still needs the required commercial authorization.

Sales: I will send the full proposed commercial terms for review.

Finance business partner: Include the renewal assumptions so the evaluation covers more than the initial booking.

Notice the professional language

Gross margin - Revenue minus cost of goods or services, often expressed as a percentage of revenue.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 09 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Audit Issue: Control Deficiency or Material Weakness?

An audit team finds repeated manual journal-entry approvals after posting.

Roles: Auditor / Controller / Finance business partner

Auditor: Approvals occurred after posting in several samples.

Controller: The entries were correct, so I do not see the issue.

Finance business partner: Accuracy helps, but the control objective is timely review before posting. A correct entry can still reveal an operating deficiency.

Controller: Are you saying it is a material weakness?

Finance business partner: Not from this evidence alone. We need to assess frequency, magnitude, compensating controls, and whether a material misstatement could reasonably occur.

Auditor: I will gather the sampling details and the control-design evidence.

Finance business partner: That will support a properly scoped assessment instead of a premature severity label.

Notice the professional language

Material weakness - A serious control deficiency creating reasonable possibility of material misstatement.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 10 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

FX Hedge Debate

A multinational company faces euro-denominated costs and dollar revenue.

Roles: Operations / Treasury / Finance business partner

Operations: The euro moved against us. Can treasury just lock the rate?

Treasury: We can hedge part of the exposure, but hedging has cost and forecast risk.

Finance business partner: The exposure is not only today's spot rate. We need forecasted euro costs, timing, confidence, hedge ratio, and whether the hedge qualifies for the accounting treatment we expect.

Operations: So what do you recommend?

Finance business partner: We should assess eligible hedging options against the treasury policy, exposure evidence, costs, and accounting requirements with qualified reviewers before recommending or executing a transaction.

Operations: I will reconcile the forecast exposure with the purchase schedule.

Finance business partner: Show the uncertainty in amount and timing before treasury reviews the alternatives.

Notice the professional language

Hedging reduces certain risks but can create cost, accounting, and forecast challenges.

Use exposure, hedge ratio, timing, and accounting-treatment language.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 11 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Performance Presentation: Fair, Accurate, Complete

A wealth team prepares a client deck after a strong quarter.

Roles: Advisor / Compliance / Finance business partner

Advisor: Let's lead with our best-performing strategy.

Compliance: Only if the performance presentation is balanced and not misleading.

Finance business partner: We should include benchmark, time period, fees basis, relevant risks, and whether the result is representative. A single strong quarter without context may create a misleading impression.

Advisor: Can we still use it?

Finance business partner: Potentially, after compliance review of the actual material and applicable requirements. Those presentation elements help provide context but do not automatically make a communication compliant.

Advisor: I will submit the complete slide and supporting figures to compliance.

Finance business partner: Keep its publication status pending until the required review is complete.

Notice the professional language

Investment performance language carries compliance and ethics risk.

Strong performance still needs context, risk, fees, and representativeness.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 12 / 7 SPEAKING TURNS

Board Update: Liquidity, Leverage, and Capital Allocation

The CFO briefs the board before approving a buyback and acquisition pipeline.

Roles: Board member / CFO / Finance business partner

Board member: Can we fund the buyback and still pursue the acquisition?

CFO: It depends on the downside case and debt capacity.

Finance business partner: Base case supports both, but the downside case tightens liquidity and pushes leverage close to our target ceiling. The decision is not only affordability; it is flexibility if revenue slows or rates stay higher.

Board member: What is management's recommendation?

Finance business partner: Authorize a smaller buyback tranche now, preserve capacity for diligence, and revisit after Q2 cash conversion and covenant forecast are updated.

Board member: I will bring the smaller tranche and alternative scenarios to the decision meeting.

Finance business partner: Include the required authorizations and preserve room to reassess as the evidence changes.

Notice the professional language

Board finance updates need recommendation, tradeoff, downside case, and decision trigger.

Capital allocation language connects cash, strategy, risk, and optionality.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Finance Communication: Drivers, Assumptions, Materiality, Risk

SHARED CASE

Revenue is 5% above budget, while operating profit is 2% below budget. A manager wants a one-sentence explanation for a review meeting.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Revenue exceeded budget, but higher operating costs more than offset the increase. I'll show the main cost drivers so the review explains why profit moved differently from revenue.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Financial Statements, Close, and Accounting Judgments

SHARED CASE

An invoice covers services delivered in December but was paid in January. A colleague asks which month should appear in the close schedule.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Are we discussing the cash payment date or the accounting period for the expense? The payment was in January; the accounting treatment needs to follow our policy and the service details.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

FP&A, Budgeting, Forecasting, and Variance Analysis

SHARED CASE

The forecast shows \$120,000 of spending against a \$100,000 budget. A new supplier fee accounts for \$15,000; the remaining \$5,000 is under review.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

Spending is forecast to be \$20,000 above budget. The supplier fee explains \$15,000 of that variance. We are still reviewing the remaining \$5,000 and will update the bridge tomorrow.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Treasury, Cash, Liquidity, Working Capital, and FX

SHARED CASE

A cash forecast assumes a large customer pays on Friday. The customer has not confirmed payment. A manager asks if the cash balance is guaranteed.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The forecast assumes payment on Friday; that date is not confirmed. I'll show the balance both with and without the receipt so the team can see the liquidity exposure.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Markets, Investments, Performance, and Client Communication

SHARED CASE

A portfolio return is 6% before fees. Its benchmark returned 5% over the same stated period. A slide does not identify fee treatment.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Useful expressions

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Cover this until after your first attempt

The figures suggest a one-percentage-point difference before fees. We should label fee treatment and confirm the comparison basis before describing the performance to a client.

Second round

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Banking, Credit, Lending, and Counterparty Risk

SHARED CASE

A credit file is missing an updated financial statement. The review team needs it for a scheduled meeting on Thursday.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know ...

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you send the latest approved financial statements through the secure channel by Wednesday? Please confirm the reporting period, or let us know when the documents will be available.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Controls, Audit, Compliance, Fraud, and Ethics

SHARED CASE

A reconciliation has three unmatched entries. Their cause is unknown. The preparer is handing the work to a reviewer at the end of the day.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

Three entries remain unmatched. I've listed their references and the checks already completed. Please review the supporting records and record the resolution; the cause is still unconfirmed.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Valuation, M&A, Capital Allocation, and Executive Finance

SHARED CASE

A valuation model changes materially when the growth assumption moves from 2% to 4%. The presentation shows only the higher estimate.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The valuation is sensitive to the growth assumption. I'll present both scenarios and explain the assumptions behind them. The higher figure is a modeled outcome, not an assured transaction value.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Revenue ahead, operating profit behind

The lesson's review shows revenue 5% above budget and operating profit 2% below. The causes are not supplied.

01 • Finance manager: Revenue is five percent above budget, while operating profit is two percent below budget.

02 • Operations director: That sounds contradictory. Doesn't higher revenue mean the business made more operating profit?

03 • Finance manager: Revenue measures sales; operating income also reflects operating costs. The two variances can differ.

04 • Operations director: Can we say higher staff costs caused the profit shortfall in this case?

05 • Finance manager: Not from the figures provided. We haven't established the cost or mix drivers.

06 • Operations director: Then give me a one-sentence explanation that preserves what we actually know.

07 • Finance manager: Sales exceeded budget, but operating profit fell short; the reasons for that difference still need review.

08 • Operations director: That distinguishes the result from the explanation without hiding the unfavorable variance.

09 • Finance manager: Exactly. A sensitivity analysis could explore assumptions, but it wouldn't establish the actual cause.

10 • Operations director: I'll use that qualified summary and ask for the driver analysis separately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Higher revenue per unit, unchanged unit sales

Separate fictional planning exercise: revenue rises from \$100,000 to \$110,000 while unit sales remain at 1,000; the revenue breakdown is available only at this level.

01 • Sales director: Revenue rose from one hundred thousand to one hundred ten thousand dollars. We sold more units, then?

02 • Finance analyst: Unit sales stayed at one thousand. Revenue growth and volume growth aren't the same here.

03 • Sales director: So the average revenue per unit moved from one hundred to one hundred ten dollars?

04 • Finance analyst: Yes, using these totals. That doesn't tell us whether pricing, discounts, or product mix changed.

05 • Sales director: I was about to credit a higher list price for the entire variance.

06 • Finance analyst: We need the detailed breakdown before making that attribution. The average alone doesn't isolate it.

07 • Sales director: Could you explain the distinction in the meeting using those two averages?

08 • Finance analyst: Certainly. The company earned more revenue per unit in aggregate, but the underlying drivers remain unconfirmed.

09 • Sales director: I'll separate the arithmetic from the pricing explanation in my remarks.

10 • Finance analyst: Good. We'll review the transaction detail before concluding which driver caused the movement.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Sensitivity is a what-if, not a forecast update

Separate fictional model review: an analyst tests a 10% fuel-cost increase without changing the approved forecast assumptions.

01 • Business manager: Your model shows fuel cost up ten percent. Has that become our new forecast?

02 • FP&A analyst: No. It's a sensitivity test showing what changes if that assumption is varied.

03 • Business manager: Then the operating-income result is conditional, not a prediction that fuel will rise that much?

04 • FP&A analyst: Correct. The approved forecast assumptions haven't been changed by this separate test.

05 • Business manager: Why show a case we don't claim will actually occur next period?

06 • FP&A analyst: It helps explain exposure: how dependent the result is on one uncertain input.

07 • Business manager: Could other costs change at the same time in a real situation?

08 • FP&A analyst: They could. This test isolates one input and doesn't describe every possible interaction.

09 • Business manager: I'll call it a fuel-cost sensitivity and keep it separate from the forecast.

10 • FP&A analyst: That preserves the distinction between exploring risk and updating our expected financial result.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Finance Communication: Drivers, Assumptions, Materiality, Risk

Revenue is 5% above budget, while operating profit is 2% below budget. A manager wants a one-sentence explanation for a review meeting.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Revenue exceeded budget, but higher operating costs more than offset the increase. I'll show the main cost drivers so the review explains why profit moved differently from revenue.

Scenario 2 | A percentage-point correction

A fictional review reports an operating margin rising from 8% to 10%. A speaker calls that a two-percent relative increase. No causes have been investigated.

Role A: You are the finance analyst. Explain the two-percentage-point change and the different relative calculation.

Role B: You are the business manager. Paraphrase the distinction without assigning an unsupported cause.

Possible opening: The margin increased by two percentage points; that is different from a two-percent relative increase.

Success checks

- State the absolute movement as two percentage points.
- Explain that the relative increase from eight to ten is 25%.
- Keep the cause unresolved.

Add a complication: A stakeholder wants to credit automation even though no driver analysis is available.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which month does the close schedule mean?

The lesson's invoice covers services delivered in December and paid in January; accounting treatment requires contextual review.

01 • Accounts assistant: The services were delivered in December and paid in January. Which month goes in the close schedule?

02 • Financial controller: First, which column do you mean: service period, payment date, or proposed accounting period?

03 • Accounts assistant: The proposed accounting period. I assumed it should match the month cash left the bank.

04 • Financial controller: Cash timing and expense recognition are distinct. We need to check the applicable basis and supporting records.

05 • Accounts assistant: Should I ask whether an accrual was already recorded for the December services?

06 • Financial controller: Yes. That matters for reconciliation and helps avoid treating the same item twice.

07 • Accounts assistant: I'll preserve December as the service period and January as the payment period.

08 • Financial controller: Good. Don't finalize an accounting treatment solely from our short conversation.

09 • Accounts assistant: I'll bring the invoice and any accrual reference for review before changing the schedule.

10 • Financial controller: Then we can confirm the entry using the actual records and applicable accounting approach.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Cash received before the service begins

Separate fictional close exercise: a customer pays in advance for a future service; no revenue-recognition assessment has been completed.

01 • Billing analyst: The customer paid in advance. Can I label the whole receipt as this month's revenue?

02 • Controller: Could you clarify when the service is provided and what the schedule is intended to show?

03 • Billing analyst: The service is future work, and the schedule supports the financial close.

04 • Controller: Then receiving cash alone doesn't establish the revenue treatment. We need the relevant agreement and accounting assessment.

05 • Billing analyst: Is deferred revenue a label we should consider rather than assume automatically?

06 • Controller: Yes. Bring the facts for review instead of choosing a treatment from the payment date alone.

07 • Billing analyst: We haven't checked whether any part of the service has already been delivered.

08 • Controller: Keep that unknown visible. It may matter to the assessment and reconciliation.

09 • Billing analyst: I'll gather the agreement, receipt reference, and service-status information for the close reviewer.

10 • Controller: Good. We'll distinguish confirmed cash receipt from the accounting conclusion still under review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A reconciliation difference needs a cutoff question

Separate fictional close exercise: a bank export ends Friday, while the internal cash schedule includes Monday entries.

01 • Reconciliation analyst: The bank export and internal schedule don't match. Could you confirm their cutoff dates?

02 • Treasury accountant: The bank export ends Friday, but the internal schedule includes Monday entries.

03 • Reconciliation analyst: Then we are comparing different periods. That may explain part of the difference.

04 • Treasury accountant: Can we mark the entire difference resolved just by noting that mismatch?

05 • Reconciliation analyst: No. We need to align the periods and check the entries before confirming reconciliation.

06 • Treasury accountant: Would you prefer a Friday internal view or a bank export through Monday?

07 • Reconciliation analyst: Either could support a consistent comparison, provided the close reviewer confirms the required cutoff.

08 • Treasury accountant: I'll ask that focused question rather than select whichever view makes the difference disappear.

09 • Reconciliation analyst: Please retain both original extracts so the change in scope remains traceable.

10 • Treasury accountant: Agreed. We'll reconcile the matching period and report anything still unmatched afterward.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Financial Statements, Close, and Accounting Judgments

An invoice covers services delivered in December but was paid in January. A colleague asks which month should appear in the close schedule.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Are we discussing the cash payment date or the accounting period for the expense? The payment was in January; the accounting treatment needs to follow our policy and the service details.

Scenario 2 | A credit note without a linked invoice

A fictional close file contains a credit note but no linked invoice reference. Its cash settlement status and prior accounting entry are unknown.

Role A: You prepare the close schedule. Request the invoice linkage and existing-entry information before proposing treatment.

Role B: You are the billing coordinator. State what is missing and agree how to retrieve it.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which invoice this credit note relates to and whether an entry is already recorded?

Success checks

- Ask for the invoice link and prior entry.
- Preserve the unknown settlement status.
- Agree a records check rather than an unsupported accounting classification.

Add a complication: Someone suggests classifying it by the credit note's filename alone.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

A twenty-thousand-dollar bridge with a gap

The lesson's spending forecast is \$120,000 against a \$100,000 budget; \$15,000 relates to a supplier fee and \$5,000 remains under review.

01 • FP&A analyst: The forecast exceeds budget by twenty thousand dollars. Fifteen thousand relates to the new supplier fee.

02 • Department manager: Then can we say supplier costs explain the full unfavorable variance?

03 • FP&A analyst: No. The remaining five thousand is still under review and needs its own line in the bridge.

04 • Department manager: What part of the analysis is complete enough for today's discussion?

05 • FP&A analyst: The total comparison and identified supplier fee. The unexplained balance remains pending.

06 • Department manager: Does this mean we have already spent one hundred twenty thousand dollars?

07 • FP&A analyst: No. That is the forecast, not a supplied actual-spending figure.

08 • Department manager: I'll distinguish forecast from actuals and avoid filling the gap with a guessed cause.

09 • FP&A analyst: I'll update the bridge when the remaining five thousand has been investigated.

10 • Department manager: Good. Present the known driver and open balance together so the total still reconciles.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Forecast submitted but not approved

Separate fictional planning exercise: a department submitted a revised forecast; the finance review is still pending and the budget is unchanged.

01 • Department lead: We submitted the revised forecast. Can I announce that our spending budget has increased?

02 • Planning analyst: No. Submission isn't approval, and a forecast update doesn't itself change the authorized budget.

03 • Department lead: Then what progress can I report without understating the work already completed?

04 • Planning analyst: Say the revision was submitted and finance review remains pending; the budget is unchanged.

05 • Department lead: Could the forecast still help us discuss the expected variance while review continues?

06 • Planning analyst: Yes, provided it is labeled submitted rather than approved and compared with the current budget.

07 • Department lead: I'll make those statuses explicit instead of combining them into a single updated number.

08 • Planning analyst: Please also retain the original assumptions so reviewers can see what changed.

09 • Department lead: When the review finishes, we'll communicate its outcome separately from the submission milestone.

10 • Planning analyst: Exactly. That keeps progress visible without implying spending authority that hasn't been granted.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A timing shift is not a permanent saving

Separate fictional forecast review: \$12,000 of planned maintenance moved from March to April; the annual scope and total remain unchanged.

01 • Operations manager: March's forecast is twelve thousand dollars lower. Can we call that a maintenance saving?

02 • Finance analyst: The work moved to April, and the annual total hasn't changed. It's a timing shift.

03 • Operations manager: So March improves against its original plan, but the cost hasn't disappeared?

04 • Finance analyst: Correct. The bridge should show the movement between periods, not a reduction in annual scope.

05 • Operations manager: Is there anything still pending in the analysis before the monthly review?

06 • Finance analyst: We need to confirm that both months reflect the same twelve-thousand-dollar shift consistently.

07 • Operations manager: I'll avoid presenting March alone as proof of a lower full-year cost.

08 • Finance analyst: Good. The completed finding is the rescheduling; the cross-period check remains to be confirmed.

09 • Operations manager: Let's show March and April together so the timing effect is visible.

10 • Finance analyst: I'll bring that comparison and leave any actual saving claim out of the update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | FP&A, Budgeting, Forecasting, and Variance Analysis

The forecast shows \$120,000 of spending against a \$100,000 budget. A new supplier fee accounts for \$15,000; the remaining \$5,000 is under review.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: Spending is forecast to be \$20,000 above budget. The supplier fee explains \$15,000 of that variance. We are still reviewing the remaining \$5,000 and will update the bridge tomorrow.

Scenario 2 | An incomplete headcount forecast

A fictional forecast includes salary assumptions for six planned hires, but start dates for two are unconfirmed. The approved headcount budget has not changed.

Role A: You are the planning analyst. Report completed inputs and the two unresolved start-date assumptions.

Role B: You manage recruitment. Ask how the uncertainty affects the forecast without treating it as hiring approval.

Possible opening: Six roles are modeled, but two start dates are assumptions we still need to confirm.

Success checks

- Identify two unconfirmed dates out of six roles.
- Separate forecast assumptions from approved headcount.
- Agree who will check the dates and how uncertainty remains visible.

Add a complication: A sponsor asks you to present all six start dates as agreed to simplify the update.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Friday's receipt is still an assumption

The lesson's cash forecast assumes a large customer pays Friday; the customer has not confirmed payment.

01 • Operations director: The cash forecast looks sufficient. Is Friday's closing cash balance guaranteed?

02 • Treasury analyst: No. It assumes the large customer pays Friday, and that payment is unconfirmed.

03 • Operations director: Then what is the confirmed observation, as distinct from the planning assumption?

04 • Treasury analyst: The forecast includes the expected receipt. We don't yet have customer confirmation of the payment.

05 • Operations director: Could we describe liquidity as secure because the model shows enough cash?

06 • Treasury analyst: That would overstate the evidence. The modeled balance depends on the receipt arriving as assumed.

07 • Operations director: Would a delayed-receipt case help explain the exposure without predicting a delay?

08 • Treasury analyst: Yes. We can examine that scenario and clearly label it as conditional.

09 • Operations director: I'll request the payment-status check and avoid treating the base case as a guarantee.

10 • Treasury analyst: I'll present the assumption and alternative timing case together for the liquidity discussion.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An undrawn facility is not unrestricted cash

Separate fictional treasury exercise: a report lists cash and an undrawn revolver separately; availability conditions have not been reviewed.

01 • Business manager: Could we add the undrawn revolver to cash and call the total immediately available?

02 • Treasury manager: Not without reviewing availability conditions. An undrawn facility isn't the same as cash already held.

03 • Business manager: The report lists a facility amount, but doesn't confirm what can actually be drawn today.

04 • Treasury manager: Exactly. That figure alone doesn't establish usable liquidity at this moment.

05 • Business manager: Should the cash-runway discussion exclude it entirely, then, as though it had no relevance?

06 • Treasury manager: We should show it separately with the conditions unresolved, rather than assume either availability or irrelevance.

07 • Business manager: I'll ask for the facility review before presenting a combined liquidity claim.

08 • Treasury manager: Please also retain the distinction between observed cash and potential funding sources.

09 • Business manager: Then leadership can see the open question rather than mistake the headline for a guarantee.

10 • Treasury manager: Good. We'll update the assessment when the relevant conditions have actually been checked.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A currency assumption is not a locked rate

Separate fictional forecast: a foreign-currency invoice is converted using a planning rate; no executed hedge or agreed settlement rate is supplied.

01 • Procurement manager: The forecast shows a fixed domestic-currency cost. Has treasury locked that exchange rate?

02 • Treasury analyst: No executed hedge is supplied here. The figure uses a planning exchange-rate assumption.

03 • Procurement manager: So the invoice amount and its translated forecast value are different kinds of information?

04 • Treasury analyst: Yes. The translated value depends on the assumed rate, and the FX exposure remains to be assessed.

05 • Procurement manager: Could we claim the actual settlement cost will match the forecast exactly?

06 • Treasury analyst: Not from these facts. We haven't established a locked rate or the settlement conditions.

07 • Procurement manager: I'll describe the domestic-currency figure as modeled, not guaranteed cash outflow.

08 • Treasury analyst: Good. We can show rate sensitivities without implying that any one rate will occur.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll ask who can confirm the exposure and any existing arrangements before the review.

10 • Treasury analyst: Then the discussion can separate known invoice terms from uncertain conversion outcomes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Treasury, Cash, Liquidity, Working Capital, and FX

A cash forecast assumes a large customer pays on Friday. The customer has not confirmed payment. A manager asks if the cash balance is guaranteed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The forecast assumes payment on Friday; that date is not confirmed. I'll show the balance both with and without the receipt so the team can see the liquidity exposure.

Scenario 2 | Payment reported; receipt unconfirmed

A fictional customer says a payment instruction was submitted. The receiving bank record has not been checked, and the forecast currently includes the receipt today.

Role A: You are the treasury analyst. Distinguish the customer's statement from confirmed receipt.

Role B: You are the collections lead. Ask what confirmation is needed and how to describe today's cash forecast.

Possible opening: The customer reports submitting an instruction, but we haven't confirmed receipt in our bank record.

Success checks

- Attribute the customer's report accurately.
- Keep receipt and timing unconfirmed.
- Agree a bank-record check and a qualified forecast statement.

Add a complication: A manager wants the incoming amount counted as settled cash immediately.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six percent before fees needs a visible label

The lesson's portfolio return is 6% before fees and the benchmark returned 5% over the same period. Benchmark treatment needs clarification.

01 • Investment analyst: The portfolio returned six percent before fees; the benchmark returned five percent over the same period.

02 • Client reporting manager: Can the slide simply say investors outperformed by one percent?

03 • Investment analyst: We should say one percentage point on the stated figures, with fee treatment clearly identified.

04 • Client reporting manager: Because the portfolio figure doesn't establish the return each investor received after charges?

05 • Investment analyst: Correct. We also need to confirm the benchmark's calculation basis for a fair comparison.

06 • Client reporting manager: Should volatility or attribution be included if we want to discuss more than the headline return?

07 • Investment analyst: Yes, where supported. The return difference alone doesn't explain risk or the sources of performance.

08 • Client reporting manager: I'll retain the shared period and request a comparable fee basis before finalizing the claim.

09 • Investment analyst: Good. Avoid converting this historical comparison into a promise about future performance.

10 • Client reporting manager: The slide will state the measured result, its basis, and the remaining comparison limits.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Different periods cannot rank performance fairly

Separate fictional reporting exercise: fund A's summary covers twelve months, while fund B's covers six months. No matched-period figures are available.

01 • Reporting associate: Fund A's return is higher, but its summary covers twelve months and fund B's covers six.

02 • Performance specialist: Then those figures don't provide a like-for-like ranking over the same investment period.

03 • Reporting associate: Could I double the six-month result to estimate the missing twelve-month figure?

04 • Performance specialist: That would invent performance for a period we haven't measured. Request matched-period data instead.

05 • Reporting associate: Should the same benchmark and fee treatment also be checked before comparing them?

06 • Performance specialist: Yes. Different strategies may need explanation too; a single ranking can hide important differences.

07 • Reporting associate: For now, I'll display the two periods explicitly and withhold the better-performing label.

08 • Performance specialist: Good. We can discuss what the summaries show without pretending the comparison is complete.

09 • Reporting associate: I'll ask for the common-period returns and relevant volatility information.

10 • Performance specialist: Then we can describe the observed tradeoffs, not make an unsupported investment recommendation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A higher return with greater variation

Separate fictional training dataset: portfolios A and B have same-period, same-fee-basis returns of 7% and 6%; A's measured volatility is higher.

01 • Portfolio reporting lead: Portfolio A returned seven percent, versus six percent for B, on the same stated basis.

02 • Review analyst: A also had higher measured volatility. The comparison shouldn't imply the higher return came without a tradeoff.

03 • Portfolio reporting lead: Would volatility mean how much the returns varied, rather than simply whether money was lost?

04 • Review analyst: Yes. Explain the measure used; it doesn't capture every form of investment risk.

05 • Portfolio reporting lead: Then we can compare the observed return and variation without deciding which portfolio suits a client.

06 • Review analyst: Exactly. Suitability isn't established by these two historical measures alone.

07 • Portfolio reporting lead: I'll say A had a higher return and higher measured volatility in this dataset.

08 • Review analyst: Please keep the period and fee basis visible so the statement remains checkable.

09 • Portfolio reporting lead: And any attribution of that difference needs separate evidence about the underlying holdings.

10 • Review analyst: Agreed. The comparison is informative, but neither a complete risk assessment nor future guidance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Markets, Investments, Performance, and Client Communication

A portfolio return is 6% before fees. Its benchmark returned 5% over the same stated period. A slide does not identify fee treatment.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The figures suggest a one-percentage-point difference before fees. We should label fee treatment and confirm the comparison basis before describing the performance to a client.

Scenario 2 | A return series with withdrawals

A fictional portfolio's ending balance is lower than its opening balance, and the account had a withdrawal. No calculated performance return is supplied.

Role A: You prepare performance reports. Explain why balance movement alone does not identify investment return.

Role B: You review client communication. Ask for a calculation that accounts for the cash flow and a comparable benchmark basis.

Possible opening: The balance declined, but the withdrawal means that movement is not itself the investment return.

Success checks

- Separate cash flow from investment performance.
- Do not invent an unsupplied return.
- Agree to obtain the appropriate calculation before benchmarking.

Add a complication: Someone wants to call the entire balance decline a market loss.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Requesting the statement for Thursday's review

The lesson's credit file lacks an updated financial statement needed for a Thursday review meeting.

01 • Credit analyst: Could you provide the updated financial statement for the credit review scheduled on Thursday?

02 • Relationship manager: Which gap does that document address, and are you promising approval if it arrives?

03 • Credit analyst: It fills a missing part of the file. Receipt would not itself establish a credit decision.

04 • Relationship manager: I can request it from the borrower, but I can't guarantee their delivery time.

05 • Credit analyst: Please ask when it can be supplied and let us know if Thursday's review may lack it.

06 • Relationship manager: Should I also request clarification of any figures needed for the DSCR analysis?

07 • Credit analyst: Yes, identify the actual missing inputs rather than estimate them from an outdated statement.

08 • Relationship manager: I'll keep the request focused on the review evidence, not suggest a favorable outcome.

09 • Credit analyst: Thank you. Credit risk and collateral assessment remain matters for the full review.

10 • Relationship manager: I'll confirm the borrower's response and distinguish promised delivery from a document actually received.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A collateral valuation with an unknown date

Separate fictional credit review: a collateral valuation is present, but its effective date is absent from the summary.

01 • Credit reviewer: Could you confirm the valuation's effective date before we rely on this collateral summary?

02 • Loan officer: The summary has a value but no date. I haven't checked the full report.

03 • Credit reviewer: Please retrieve the report and identify its scope as well as the date.

04 • Loan officer: Would finding those details mean the collateral is sufficient for the proposed facility?

05 • Credit reviewer: No. That conclusion needs the relevant review; this request addresses an evidence gap only.

06 • Loan officer: I'll ask for the report through the file process and confirm when it's available.

07 • Credit reviewer: If it can't be obtained before the review, flag the limitation rather than substitute an assumption.

08 • Loan officer: Understood. I'll avoid presenting the summary value as a current verified assessment.

09 • Credit reviewer: Good. We need the basis before discussing how collateral affects the credit-risk analysis.

10 • Loan officer: I'll return the source details or a clear statement of what remains missing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Requesting the model definition behind default risk

Separate fictional credit exercise: a dashboard shows a probability-of-default estimate with no model version or horizon stated.

01 • Risk manager: Could you identify the horizon and model version behind this probability-of-default estimate?

02 • Credit data analyst: Those fields aren't in the dashboard extract. I'll need to check the model documentation.

03 • Risk manager: Please do that before the estimate is compared with the other portfolio's figure.

04 • Credit data analyst: Is the concern that a one-year estimate may not match a differently defined measure?

05 • Risk manager: Exactly. We need comparable definitions, not merely two percentages with the same label.

06 • Credit data analyst: Should I describe this estimate as a prediction that the borrower will default?

07 • Risk manager: No. It is a model estimate requiring context, not a certain individual outcome.

08 • Credit data analyst: I'll request the documentation and note that the comparison remains incomplete.

09 • Risk manager: Please confirm realistic delivery timing rather than promise it before checking access.

10 • Credit data analyst: I'll return the definitions and source references, or flag any remaining gap promptly.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Banking, Credit, Lending, and Counterparty Risk

A credit file is missing an updated financial statement. The review team needs it for a scheduled meeting on Thursday.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you send the latest approved financial statements through the secure channel by Wednesday? Please confirm the reporting period, or let us know when the documents will be available.

Scenario 2 | Debt-service inputs need a period check

A fictional credit worksheet combines annual cash-flow figures with a quarterly debt-service figure. The correct matching-period inputs have not been obtained.

Role A: You are the credit analyst. Request matching-period inputs before relying on the DSCR calculation.

Role B: You maintain the financial file. Clarify the two periods and agree how to obtain the needed figures.

Possible opening: Could you provide debt service for the same period as the cash-flow figure before we use this ratio?

Success checks

- Identify the annual-versus-quarterly mismatch.
- Separate arithmetical calculation from a meaningful ratio.
- Request the correct inputs without inventing credit thresholds or an approval outcome.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests presenting the existing ratio because the arithmetic works.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three unmatched entries at handoff

The lesson's preparer hands over a reconciliation with three unmatched entries whose cause is unknown.

01 • Reconciliation preparer: I'm handing over the reconciliation with three entries still unmatched. Their cause hasn't been established.

02 • Finance reviewer: What is complete, and where can I see the three outstanding items?

03 • Reconciliation preparer: The matching work completed so far is recorded, and the outstanding entries are identified in the working file.

04 • Finance reviewer: Should I treat them as evidence of fraud or a confirmed control deficiency?

05 • Reconciliation preparer: No. Unmatched entries require review; their existence alone doesn't establish either conclusion.

06 • Finance reviewer: I'll investigate the supporting records while preserving the preparer's work and review separation.

07 • Reconciliation preparer: Good. Please keep any proposed adjustments separate from entries that have actually been approved.

08 • Finance reviewer: Understood. No unexplained balance will be silently removed just to make the reconciliation match.

09 • Reconciliation preparer: Could you confirm your next action so the end-of-day handoff is clear?

10 • Finance reviewer: I'll review the three items and report findings and unresolved questions through the normal control process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A review signature with missing evidence

Separate fictional control review: a payment file has a reviewer signature, but the referenced supporting document is absent.

01 • Control tester: The file has a review signature, but the referenced supporting document is missing from the material I received.

02 • Audit manager: Have you established that the review wasn't performed, or only that evidence is unavailable?

03 • Control tester: Only the evidence gap. I haven't confirmed what the reviewer actually examined.

04 • Audit manager: Then hand that limitation over without calling it a proven control failure.

05 • Control tester: I'll identify the payment reference and missing document in the restricted testing record.

06 • Audit manager: What follow-up are you asking the next reviewer to perform on this item?

07 • Control tester: Seek the support and assess what it shows about the review, without recreating evidence as though original.

08 • Audit manager: I'll take that request and retain the distinction between performance and documentation.

09 • Control tester: Please record any further evidence and whether the testing conclusion changes.

10 • Audit manager: Agreed. The current status is an unresolved evidence gap, not a completed adverse finding.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An access overlap needs assessment

Separate fictional controls exercise: an access report shows one person can prepare and approve payments; actual use of those permissions has not been checked.

01 • Internal control analyst: The access report shows one person with preparation and approval permissions. I'm handing it over for review.

02 • Controls manager: Does the report show they actually approved a payment they prepared?

03 • Internal control analyst: No. We have the permission overlap, not a confirmed transaction-level event.

04 • Controls manager: Then the segregation-of-duties concern needs assessment without assuming misuse or intent.

05 • Internal control analyst: I'll provide the role report and note that actual activity hasn't been examined.

06 • Controls manager: Are you asking me to approve a removal or to assess the exposure first?

07 • Internal control analyst: Assess it and identify the authorized response. I haven't established the full operational context.

08 • Controls manager: I'll review the permissions and relevant evidence through the controls process.

09 • Internal control analyst: Please confirm who owns any follow-up so the concern doesn't disappear after handoff.

10 • Controls manager: I'll own the assessment and distinguish recommendations from changes that are actually authorized and completed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Controls, Audit, Compliance, Fraud, and Ethics

A reconciliation has three unmatched entries. Their cause is unknown. The preparer is handing the work to a reviewer at the end of the day.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Three entries remain unmatched. I've listed their references and the checks already completed. Please review the supporting records and record the resolution; the cause is still unconfirmed.

Scenario 2 | An exception report with an unchecked duplicate

A fictional payment exception report flags two records with the same invoice number. Their amounts and supplier identifiers have not been compared. No duplicate payment is confirmed.

Role A: You prepare controls reports. Hand over the flagged pair and state the unperformed checks.

Role B: You are the reviewer. Confirm the next comparison and avoid assuming fraud or duplicate payment.

Possible opening: Two records share an invoice number, but the supplier and amount checks are still pending.

Success checks

- Distinguish an exception flag from a confirmed duplicate.
- Name the missing comparisons.
- Confirm review ownership and preserve the absence of any recovery finding.

Add a complication: A manager wants the case title to say duplicate payment recovered, although no recovery occurred.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Showing both growth assumptions

The lesson's valuation changes materially between 2% and 4% growth assumptions, but the presentation shows only the higher estimate.

01 • Valuation analyst: The model changes materially when growth moves from two to four percent, but we show only the higher estimate.

02 • Finance director: Could the higher figure be presented as the company's established value?

03 • Valuation analyst: No. It depends on an assumption, and the sensitivity should be visible to the decision group.

04 • Finance director: Would including both estimates imply that every value between them is equally likely?

05 • Valuation analyst: Not automatically. The sensitivity illustrates model dependence; it doesn't assign probabilities to the assumptions.

06 • Finance director: We should explain that distinction alongside the DCF result in plain language.

07 • Valuation analyst: Yes. Discounted cash flow uses modeled future cash flows and a discount rate, both requiring support.

08 • Finance director: I'll ask for the growth rationale and keep the alternative case in the presentation.

09 • Valuation analyst: I'll also identify other assumptions held constant rather than imply growth is the only uncertainty.

10 • Finance director: Good. Our conclusion will match the evidence, not the most attractive model output.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Enterprise value is not the equity proceeds

Separate fictional transaction model: a slide labels enterprise value as shareholder proceeds; debt and cash adjustments have not been assessed.

01 • Transaction manager: The model gives enterprise value. Can I call that the amount shareholders would receive?

02 • Corporate finance analyst: Not on the supplied analysis. Enterprise value and equity proceeds are different measures.

03 • Transaction manager: What needs to be checked before we explain the difference to executives?

04 • Corporate finance analyst: The relevant debt, cash, and transaction adjustments need assessment; they aren't supplied here.

05 • Transaction manager: Then I shouldn't fill the bridge with assumed zero balances to simplify the slide.

06 • Corporate finance analyst: Correct. Missing adjustments must stay visible rather than become invented facts.

07 • Transaction manager: Could we retain enterprise value as a model output while marking proceeds unestablished?

08 • Corporate finance analyst: Yes. Also keep the model assumptions attached so the figure isn't presented as a guaranteed price.

09 • Transaction manager: I'll request the missing bridge inputs and correct the shareholder-proceeds label.

10 • Corporate finance analyst: Then the discussion can distinguish the modeled valuation from a transaction outcome not yet established.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A lower discount rate is not new operating evidence

Separate fictional valuation exercise: cash-flow forecasts stay unchanged while an analyst lowers the model's WACC; the assumption has not been approved.

01 • Strategy director: The valuation increased after your update. Did the business generate stronger forecast cash flows?

02 • Valuation analyst: No. The cash flows are unchanged; I tested a lower weighted average cost of capital.

03 • Strategy director: So the change reflects the WACC assumption rather than new operating evidence?

04 • Valuation analyst: Exactly. It's a sensitivity case, and the revised rate hasn't been approved.

05 • Strategy director: Can we say the company has become more valuable because this output is higher?

06 • Valuation analyst: That would confuse a model change with an established change in the business or market assessment.

07 • Strategy director: I'll ask for the rate rationale and compare the outputs with the assumptions stated.

08 • Valuation analyst: Good. We should hold the cash-flow basis constant when explaining this particular sensitivity.

09 • Strategy director: The presentation will identify the tested input and avoid calling the case an approved valuation.

10 • Valuation analyst: That makes the result transparent without treating a chosen discount rate as a discovered fact.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Valuation, M&A, Capital Allocation, and Executive Finance

A valuation model changes materially when the growth assumption moves from 2% to 4%. The presentation shows only the higher estimate.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The valuation is sensitive to the growth assumption. I'll present both scenarios and explain the assumptions behind them. The higher figure is a modeled outcome, not an assured transaction value.

Scenario 2 | Savings enter the model before costs

A fictional acquisition model includes proposed annual savings but excludes integration costs because they have not been estimated. No net-benefit conclusion is approved.

Role A: You review the valuation. Explain the missing cost side and limit the claim.

Role B: You sponsor the acquisition analysis. Ask what estimate is needed before discussing net value.

Possible opening: The model includes proposed savings, but it cannot yet establish net benefit without integration costs.

Success checks

- Separate proposed savings from realized benefits.
- Identify unestimated integration costs.
- Agree a fuller assessment without assigning invented values or certainty.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to call the savings guaranteed value creation.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Investor.gov: investing glossary

<https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/glossary>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Finance English

Professional audience: accounting, FP&A, treasury, banking, investments, audit, risk, corporate finance, and finance-adjacent teams

Scope: Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Dialogue 01: Monthly Close: Revenue Miss or Timing Issue?

Original fictional setting: Finance reviews monthly results before sending the executive package.

Professional roles: Controller / FP&A lead / Finance business partner

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

Controller: Revenue is 4 percent below forecast. Is this a real miss or timing?

FP&A lead: Part of it is timing. Two enterprise renewals slipped into next month.

Finance business partner: Can we separate accounting timing from underlying demand? Revenue recognition depends on the actual contracts, performance, and applicable accounting policy, not just signature date. Let's reconcile those details before calling this a timing-only variance.

Controller: What should the commentary say?

Finance business partner: The renewals are one reported driver, but the accounting bridge still needs verification. We should also assess the SMB churn data before drawing a conclusion about recurring demand.

Controller: I will reconcile renewal timing with the revenue-recognition entries before we finalize the bridge.

Finance business partner: Please include the churn evidence and distinguish confirmed drivers from the open analysis.

Vocabulary in this exchange: Revenue: Income from delivering goods or services, recognized under applicable accounting rules. / Forecast: Updated estimate of future performance based on current information. / Variance: Difference between actual and comparison point such as budget, forecast, or prior period. / Bridge: Step-by-step explanation from one financial number to another. / Reconcile: Compare records, identify differences, and resolve them.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

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Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Extend the conversation library

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level